Buildable Animation Nodes

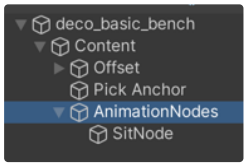
This is a guide for artists/designers for working with our Buildable Animation Node system. This system lets NPCs in town interact with buildings and decos for a more immersive and fun experience.

Animation nodes are points on a deco or building that define a position, orientation, and animation for an NPC. Each node can be occupied by one NPC at a time. Some examples include: sitting on a bench, standing in line at the bakery, and standing under Macaroni's tree.

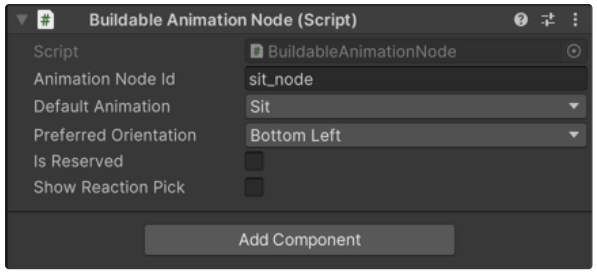
How To

Buildable Animation Nodes are designed to be easy to set up and flexible. Follow this guide for adding/editing nodes.

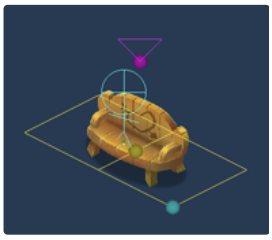
- Double click the prefab you want to edit to enter Prefab Edit Mode
- Add a new object underneath the Content container by right-clicking on Content and selecting Create Empty. The name doesn't matter but AnimationNodes is a good convention



- Create a child object for each node you want to add. Give it a helpful name, whatever you'd like.
- Add a Buildable Animation Node component to the child object. Each node on a prefab *must have a unique id*. The preferred orientation is relative to the default orientation for the prefab and will flip with the building.
  - Is Reserved is for special story nodes such as the spaces under Macaroni's tree, or Cindi's position next to Charmy's tent during early game. These nodes will not be occupied by NPCs wandering randomly around town. Keep this **unchecked** for most cases.
  - Show Reaction Pick is for things like the bakery where NPCs can react with an icon over their head. By design we only want the first character in line to show this pick so this optional toggle was added. Keep this **unchecked** for most cases.



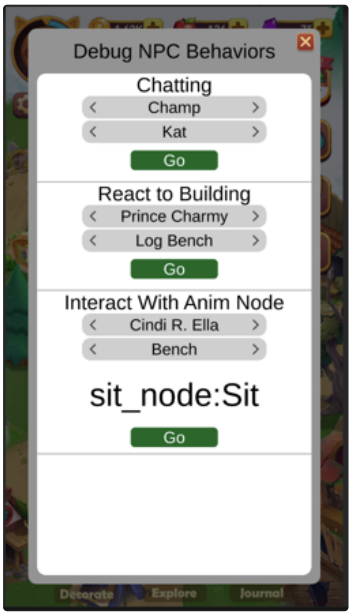
- Preview the node's position until you're happy with the outcome. There's a cyan skeleton mock roughly showing where the NPC will stand.



- You're all done! It's really that easy 🙂

Testing

- Test your changes with the debug menu. Select NPC Debug Dialog to open the NPC interactions debug dialog.



- Here you can scroll through each NPC and select a behavior to force trigger. For Animation Nodes use the third section "Interact with Anim Node" and scroll until you find the deco you want to test.
- The Go button will drop the character next to the deco and try to trigger the interact behavior. If there are no available nodes the character will just stand next to it.